FAIR ASSESS NJ

PUBLIC ASSESSMENT EQUITY

A free website that helps Bergen County homeowners see if their home is assessed fairly for property taxes.

WHAT I FOUND

In New Milford, the cheapest quarter of sold homes was assessed at about 97% of its sale price. The most expensive quarter: about 81%.

(An **assessment ratio** is assessed value divided by sale price.) When cheaper homes have higher ratios, their owners pay more than their fair share: a **regressive** pattern.

I studied 3,806 single-family home sales in Bergen County (July 2025 to June 2026). Of the 48 towns with enough sales to rank: 28 are within the international standard (IAAO), 17 show mixed signals, 2 show a regressive pattern, and 1 shows the opposite.

CHECKED AGAINST THE STATE

70 of 70

towns: the same sales as the state (5,141 sales)

70 of 70

towns: my ratio within 5 points of the state's, using the state's method

HOW THE APPEAL CHECKER WORKS

1. **Pick your town and enter your assessed value** from your tax bill. Nothing you type leaves your browser.
2. **It compares recent sales** of homes with similar assessed values in your town to estimate a market value range.
3. **It applies New Jersey's Chapter 123 test** (the state's rule for when an assessment is too high) and explains the result in plain English.

EXAMPLE RESULT (A MADE-UP HOME)

Teaneck, assessed at $450,000. Estimated market value $601,494 (likely $551,857 to $655,584). Result: **within the normal range**.



This home's ratio	74.81%
Lower limit	74.32%
Upper limit	100.54% (tested as 100%)
Town average	87.43%

Green is the town's **common level range**, the band the state allows around its average ratio. Above it (gold) may mean grounds to appeal. The navy bar is this home.

Appeals for tax year 2027 are due **April 1, 2027** (May 1, 2027 in towns with a 2027 revaluation). The filing fee is $5 to $150, depending on the assessed value ($25 for this home).

Built by Zaden Pothacamury, Ramapo High School.

Data: NJ Division of Taxation, SR1A sales files (https://www.nj.gov/treasury/taxation/lpt/statdata.shtml); NJ Division of Taxation, Chapter 123 ratios for tax year 2027; deadlines and fees: NJ Form A-1, Petition of Appeal (with instructions). Data as of 2026-06-30.

Fair Assess NJ is an independent student research project that uses public data. It is not legal, tax, or appraisal advice. Homeowners file and present their own appeals. Confirm deadlines, fees, and forms with the Bergen County Board of Taxation.

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